



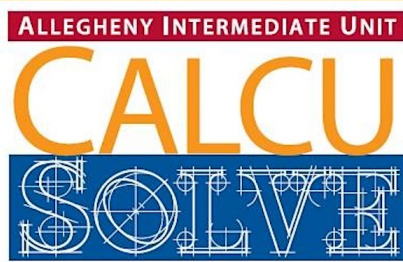
November 5th – MPR

1:45am-12:30pm

There are still a few spots left!

The American Mathematics Competition is sponsored by the Mathematical Association of America, whose goal is to identify talent and foster a love for mathematics. Students are given 75 minutes to solve 25 multiple choice questions. The competition will take place during 3rd period in early November 5 in the MPR (near the TV studio). FCAHS pays the fee for participants. If you would like to participate, all you have to do is email Lisa_Gibson@fcsd.edu.

Calculus Competition!



Dec. 16th – 9:30am – noon

CalcuSolve (grades 9-12) is a math competition where students compete individually and as part of a team of 4 students. There are 9 math problems, 7 individual and 2 team problems. Students earn points based on correct answers given during a set amount of time. Email Lesley_Cowles@fcsd.edu if you would like to be added to the list of participants.

IMPORTANT DATES:

11/1: AP Exam registration form due (for 1st semester classes)

11/1: Summer FCAO course registration opens (Health, College & Finance Essentials, SAT Prep)

11/2: Lumiere Scholars Essay Award submission deadline

11/3: Third Judicial Circuit Video Competition submission deadline

11/3: Half day of school

11/4: No School

11/5: American Mathematics Competition

11/5: Math Madness – QRT

11/15: Introduce a Girl to Engineering Day

11/15: CMU's High School Day

11/13: Math Madness – QRT

11/13: All-Star Leadership Day

11/20: Career Speakers – QRT

11/25: Mu Alpha Theta ASMA Math Competition (QRT, Library)

11/25: Patriots of the American Revolution Essay Contest submission deadline

11/26: Half day of school

11/27 – 12/1: No School

UPMC St. Margaret Volunteer and Job/Surgery Shadowing Opportunities

During our recent visit to UPMC St. Margaret for "Tour Your Future," we learned that there are many opportunities to explore career pathways related to medicine through their volunteer and job shadowing programs. Debbie Staas, the Director of Recruiting for UPMC St. Margaret

(staasdm@upmc.edu;

412-784-4081) is a valuable

resource for such placements. Students who want to volunteer at the hospital can discuss their career interests with her and she can arrange for them to volunteer in departments that will give them more exposure to those career paths of interest. Additionally, Ms. Staas helps to place students in a variety of job shadowing experiences (and even occasional surgery observations when possible).

Volunteer Requirements at UPMC St. Margaret:

- Must be 15 years of age or older.
- Complete the online application. Attend orientation (applicants will be called with upcoming orientation dates).
- Interview with Volunteer Director to discuss interests, availability, and possible assignments.
- Have a valid Social Security Number.

For more information and to apply to become a volunteer, visit:

<https://www.upmc.com/locations/hospitals/st-margaret/about/volunteer>



GOVERNOR'S SCHOOL

FOR GLOBAL AND INTERNATIONAL STUDIES 

Why Apply to Governor's School?

The program's unique curriculum and residential environment encourages students to think critically and engage with the world in a fun, rigorous, and immersive way.



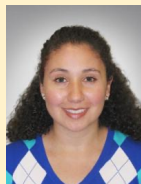
The world is becoming more and more interconnected: cultures are fusing and clashing, borders are eroding as walls are going up; local affairs are increasingly enmeshed in global and transnational processes. The Governor's School for Global and International Studies provides high-school **sophomores and juniors** with the tools to understand these changes through a four-week residential program on the University of Pittsburgh's main campus. Students learn to think globally, develop their oral and written communication skills, and study critical languages with distinguished faculty and guests and a diverse group of students from across the state. The program's unique curriculum and residential environment encourage students to engage with the world in a fun, intense, and immersive way. The knowledge and relationships they build will last a lifetime.

The cost of the 2026 Governor's School program is **\$4000**. This includes 6 credits from Pitt. Scholarships are available based on financial need to students who are Pennsylvania residents. The applicant must be a current sophomore or junior in secondary school or homeschooled and will be between 16-17 years old by the time of the program. The applicant who accepts an invitation to attend the program must commit to being in residence for the entire program, which does not allow trips home or other absences. Completed application must be submitted in a single package postmarked by January 21st, 2026.

Governor's School 2026 will take place from June 27th to July 25th, 2026.

<https://www.govschool.pitt.edu/>

Nov. 20th Career Speakers - QRT



Damaris Mohr, PA-C, specializes in orthopedic surgery and is certified by the National Commission on Certification of Physician Assistants. She practices at UPMC St. Margaret Harmar Outpatient Center and is affiliated with UPMC St. Margaret, UPMC Children's Hospital of Pittsburgh, and UPMC Shadyside



Madeline Wos, Physician Assistant Certified Physician Assistant to Dr. Bradley CMI- Burke and Bradley Orthopedics Vice Chair for UPMC St. Margaret APP Council UPMC St. Margaret & Children's Hospital



Pennsylvania Governor's School for the Sciences

proudly hosted by **Carnegie Mellon University**

Pennsylvania Governor's School for the Sciences

applications are now available for **JUNIORS**. Offering opportunities rarely available at even the best high schools, PGSS is an **ungraded** summer enrichment program which is in session for five weeks (June 21-July 25), seven days per week. All students are required to live on the CMU campus in a college dormitory. It is an intense program in which the students take lecture courses in biology, chemistry, physics, mathematics and computer science. In addition, they are expected to participate in their choice of one laboratory course in either biology, chemistry, physics, or computer science, and to engage in team research projects in one of the above five major discipline areas. The students also have the opportunity to take elective courses which may vary from year to year, to participate in several field trips, and to be further enriched by a distinguished guest lecture series.

Learn more and apply by visiting <https://sciences.pa-gov-schools.org> *Application deadline is January 31st*

Carnegie Mellon University

Pre-College Programs

The applications for CMU's Pre-College programs are expected to open in early December. Selection is competitive, so now is a good time to check out their program offerings and application requirements so that you are ready to get started on your application as soon as they are open! You can also ask for letters of recommendation early! <https://www.cmu.edu/pre-college/>



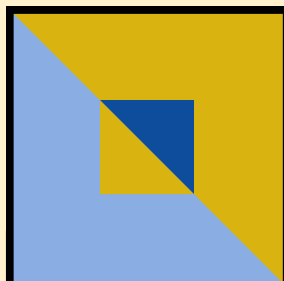
North American Computational Linguistics Open Competition

NACLO (the North American Computational Linguistics Open competition) is a contest for US

and Canadian pre-university students in which contestants solve compelling puzzles in linguistics and computational linguistics. Requiring no previous knowledge of linguistics, languages, or computing, these puzzles can be solved by analytical reasoning alone. They serve as a fun and educational introduction to a field many high school students are unfamiliar with. Winners of NACLO are eligible to compete in the International Linguistics Olympiad (IOL), one of about twelve International Science Olympiads aimed at high school students.

Registration for this competition is now open. The competition will be held on Thursday, January 29th and the invitation round on March 19th. Email Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu if you want to participate in this competition.

**Because this is a LOCAL contest,
your chances of winning are increased! Give it a try!**



STUDENT CONTESTS

Biomedical Research Saves Lives!

Both Human and Animal

Poster Contest

Eligibility: All K-12th grade students in Pennsylvania, Delaware, and West Virginia

Details: The Poster Contest has the following themes:

- 3 R's: Replacement, Reduction, Refinement
- Advancements in Biotechnology
- Animal Research Saves Lives
- Careers in Biomedical Research
- Veterinary Advancements: Animal Research Helping Animals

Provides the opportunity to illustrate different aspects of biomedical research and science through art.

Awards: CASH PRIZES and an invitation to our Annual Awards Dinner at the Hershey Lodge in Hershey, PA on Friday, June 14, 2024.

Essay Contests

Eligibility: All 6th -12th grade students in Pennsylvania, Delaware, and West Virginia,

Details: The Essay Contest is divided into two separate contests:

Topics 6th, 7th & 8th Grade = What is Biomedical Research?
High School = Biomedical Research and My Life

Learn how biomedical research, including the role of animals in research, leads to new medical treatments and cures.

Awards: CASH PRIZES and an invitation to our Annual Awards Dinner at the Hershey Lodge in Hershey, PA on Friday, June 14, 2024.

Digital Media Contest

Eligibility: All 6th -12th grade students in Pennsylvania, Delaware, and West Virginia

Theme: Biomedical Research and My Life

Details: All entries must be in a digital media format and no more than 3 minutes. Students may work as individuals or in groups of 2-5.

Recognizes students who digitally demonstrate a connection between biomedical research and their life.

Awards: CASH PRIZES and an invitation to our Annual Awards Dinner at the Hershey Lodge in Hershey, PA on Friday, June 14, 2024.

Submission Deadline: March 10, 2024

Questions?

Email contests@psbr.org or call
Lisa Cassaro, PSBR Program
Coordinator, at 717-731-3559

For more information, visit our
[Contests page](#) and click on
Poster or Essay or Digital Media
Contest

**SPARC
Science** 
A program of: **psbr** Pennsylvania Society for
Biomedical Research

www.psbr.org

Fox Chapel Area Online Summer 2026 Course Offerings

Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11.

Online courses run for 5 weeks from

Friday, June 12 through Friday, July 17

Application deadline: February 28, 2026

FCAO Career and Financial Essentials



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **Career and Financial Essentials** complements all disciplines and other standards by developing postsecondary goals regarding career planning and financial literacy. Students will embark on a career search, compose a job application, and develop a personal résumé. Students will also learn about consumer skills, debit/credit, budgeting, and taxes. The culminating experience is a one-on-one professional interview that will be conducted in the fall. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.

.5 credits

FCAO SAT Prep



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **SAT Prep** helps students strengthen their skills using Khan Academy's SAT Practice modules to build test readiness. Students will complete two full-length, timed SAT practice tests to simulate real testing conditions and track their progress. Lessons focus on improving performance in Reading, Writing, and Math. Additionally, students learn test-taking strategies, including familiarity with the Bluebook testing app utilized by College Board. Weekly assignments help students stay accountable and steadily improve their scores.

.5 credits

FCAO Discovery Health



For students entering 10th grade, **Discovery Health** allows students to apply wellness concepts to the study of the human body. Utilizing basic facts about the body systems, students will discover how daily decisions can impact the operation of the human body. This is a required course for graduation from FCAHS. It meets the PA State Standards for Health, Safety, and Physical Education. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.

.5 credits

**** These are compressed courses. Students are completing an entire course in five weeks. ****

Frequently Asked Questions:

What is the format of these classes? These classes are fully online & asynchronous, with weekly due dates.

What if a student is on vacation for part of the 5 weeks? Students can choose to work while on vacation or complete their assignments ahead of time. The late work policy will apply to all students, regardless of travel plans, so it is important to plan accordingly.

What is the late work policy? Late work is accepted up to one week with a 20% penalty; no work is accepted beyond one week late. No work is accepted beyond the last day of class, Friday, July 17th. The expectation is that all students will follow the course schedule due to the compressed nature of the classes.

How much should be expected for these classes? These classes are the same semester-long classes compressed into five weeks.

Can a student take more than one course? It is possible, but the student should consider their schedule and availability to complete multiple semester courses in a five-week span.

How do I register? Spaces are limited and classes get full. Spots are filled on a first-come, first-serve basis. A student isn't enrolled until the form AND check are received. No refunds are available after June 1st.

Fox Chapel Area Online
Summer High School Course Registration
Courses run from June 12 – July 17
Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11
Registration Deadline: February 28, 2026

I would like to register for the following summer course(s):

- ☐ FCAO College and Career Essentials (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO SAT Prep (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO Health (grade 10), \$200.00
-

Student Name: _____

Current Grade Level (circle): 9 10 11

Student Email: _____@student.fcasd.edu

Student Phone : _____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

Parent/Guardian Phone: _____

Parent/Guardian Email: _____

SPACE IS VERY LIMITED!
STUDENTS ARE NOT ENROLLED
UNTIL REGISTRATION AND PAYMENT ARE SUBMITTED.
NO REFUNDS after June 1, 2026.

Please make check payable (separate check per course) to:

Fox Chapel Area School District (FCASD)

Submit check and form either in-person (high school room 168) or via mail to:

Lisa Gibson
FCAHS Summer School Registration
611 Field Club Road
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

Contact Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu (412-967-2479) with any questions.